

Chi Zhang

ZJU-UIUC Institute, Undergraduate, Electrical and Computer Engineering

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Education

Zhejiang University, ZJU-UIUC Institute	2023.09 – Present
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)	2025.08 – 2026.05
Major	Electrical and Computer Engineering
GPA	ZJU: 3.72/4.0; UIUC: 3.84/4.0
English	TOEFL 99 (R30 / L25 / S22 / W22)
Core Courses	Large Language Model Reasoning for Engineering Applications (ECE498, A), Principles of Safe Autonomy (ECE484, A), Artificial Intelligence (ECE448, A), Operating Systems (ECE391, B+), Engineering Probability (ECE313, A-), Differential Equations (MATH285, A-), Data Structures and Algorithms (CS225, A), Discrete Mathematics (MATH213, A), Signals and Systems (ECE210, A+)

Research and Projects

[Summer Research] Masklet + Partial-Order UAV-View Action Recognition	2026.05 – Present
<i>ZJU-UIUC Institute, Advisor: Xinbo Yu</i>	
- Built UAV-Human RGB training/evaluation pipelines with MMAction2, SlowFast, and VideoMAE; designed person crop, soft masklet crop, and masklet-token variants for small-object, background, and long-tail issues. - Studied FAR, DiffAR, SaStNet and StaRNet protocol, covering split, preprocessing, script and evaluating metric; soft masklet crop module improved VideoMAE-B Top-1 from 29.37% to 46.13% on the local CSV1 validation.	
[Course Project] DroneDream: Autonomous UAV Control-Parameter Tuning	2026.01 – 2026.05
<i>ECE498 LLM Reasoning for Engineering Applications Final Project, Advisor: Bin Hu GitHub</i>	
Built a PX4/Gazebo SITL web platform for UAV parameter tuning, integrating mission setup, track editing, async optimization, live monitoring, 2D/3D replay, PDF export, artifacts, reports, and heuristic/GPT suggestions.	
[Remote Visiting] Implicit VideoQA with Action-Intent Dual-Cue Reasoning	2025.12 – 2026.05
<i>Shenzhen Institute of Advanced Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Advisor: Bin Li GitHub</i>	
Built an action-intent dual-cue cyclic gain mechanism to guide LLMs in locating fine-grained visual evidence and reasoning about hidden human intentions through the constrained inference loop for the implicit VideoQA.	
[Course Project] Autonomous UAV Tracking with State + Vision Dual Control	2025.10 – 2025.12
<i>ECE484 Principles of Safe Autonomy Final Project, Advisor: Huan Zhang GitHub Youtube</i>	
Built a dual-control system combining neural visual perception and Extended Kalman Filtering; implemented state-controller code and tested circle, u-turn, and lemniscate tracking with NPE perception and gate detection.	
[Summer Research] Tunnel Collision and Fire Detection Based on YOLOv11	2025.07 – 2025.08
<i>ZJU-UIUC Institute, Advisor: Jixing Cao GitHub</i>	
Built a tunnel dataset and trained a YOLOv11 detector for vehicles, fire, and collision events in the tunnel; completed training, prediction testing, and real-time webcam/video inference under high-confidence settings.	
[National Innovation, Excellent] High-Speed Interconnect EM Study	2024.05 – 2025.05
<i>ZJU-UIUC Institute, Advisor: Hanzhi Ma GitHub</i>	
- Built signal-channel and circuit-level co-simulation models with HFSS/ADS, and trained SVM/DNN models to predict eye height and eye width from 1,200 cleaned simulation samples for the signal-integrity analysis. - Served as project lead for modeling, simulation, core code, and final report; applied a multi-objective optimizer called MOEDO to search optimal via, pad and anti-pad radius parameters under the given jitter variables.	

Awards and Honors

Grainger Engineering Dean's List, UIUC	2025
Outstanding Student Backbone, Zhejiang University	2025
Outstanding League Cadre, Zhejiang University	2025
Mathematical Contest in Modeling, Honorable Mention	2025
Outstanding Summer Research Project and Poster Award	2024

Research Skills

Programming	Python, C/C++
Deep Learning	PyTorch, MMAction2, OpenCV, YOLO
Languages	TOEFL 99; independent English literature reading and project presentation